Student Housing in Ottawa, Canada

Comprehensive Guide for Students

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1. Introduction

Ottawa, the capital city of Canada, is one of the most student-friendly cities in the country. Known for its balance between urban life and natural beauty, it offers a wide range of housing options suitable for both domestic and international students.

Student housing in Ottawa is designed to accommodate different budgets, preferences, and lifestyles. Whether a student prefers independent living, shared accommodation, or on-campus residence, the city provides flexible and accessible solutions.

This document provides a detailed overview of student housing services, accommodation types, living conditions, and practical guidelines for students planning to live in Ottawa.

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2. Student Housing Services in Ottawa

Several platforms and services are available to help students find suitable accommodation. These services simplify the search process by offering verified listings, flexible lease options, and student-oriented features.

2.1 University Living

Best for: International students and first-time renters

What You Get:

- Fully furnished rooms (bed, desk, wardrobe, TV)
- Bills often included (Wi-Fi, electricity, heating)
- Shared or private options

Typical Costs:

- Shared room: **CAD $700 – $900/month**
- Private room: **CAD $900 – $1,300/month**
- Studio: **CAD $1,200 – $1,600/month**

Booking Process:

1. Search Ottawa properties

2. Select room type
3. Pay deposit (usually 1 month rent)
4. Upload ID & student proof
5. Confirm booking

Best Feature: Full support for international students (visa, move-in help)

2.2 4stay

Best for: Short-term or flexible stays

What You Get:

- Furnished apartments or homestays
- No long lease required
- Flexible move-in dates

Typical Costs:

- Shared housing: **CAD $600 – $850/month**
- Private room: **CAD $850 – $1,200/month**

Booking Process:

- Choose listing
- Contact host or book instantly
- Some listings require **no upfront payment**

Best Feature: Ideal for students staying **less than 6 months**

2.3 Rentola

Best for: Budget-friendly independent rentals

What You Get:

- Apartments, studios, shared housing
- Filters for price, location, and amenities

Typical Costs:

- Room: **CAD $500 – $800/month**

- Apartment: **CAD $1,000 – $1,500/month**

Booking Process:

- Search listings
- Contact landlord directly
- Arrange viewing
- Sign lease agreement

Best Feature: Large number of low-cost listings

2.4 Apartments.com

Best for: Verified off-campus apartments

What You Get:

- Professional listings
- Detailed property info and photos

Typical Costs:

- Studio: **CAD $1,200 – $1,500/month**
- 1-bedroom: **CAD $1,400 – $2,000/month**

Booking Process:

- Browse listings
- Contact property manager
- Submit rental application
- Pay deposit + first month rent

Best Feature: Reliable listings with fewer scams

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3. Real Student Housing Options in Ottawa

Below are **actual student-friendly housing properties** you can search and book:

3.1 1Eleven

Type: Apartment-style (near downtown)

Features:

- Modern furnished apartments
- Gym, study areas, lounge
- Close to public transport

Cost:

- Shared: **~CAD $900/month**
- Private: **~CAD $1,300/month**

3.2 417 Nelson

Type: Near-campus housing

Features:

- Walking distance to university
- Student-focused environment

Cost:

- Rooms: **CAD $800 – $1,100/month**

3.3 Algonquin College Residence

Type: On-campus residence

Features:

- Fully furnished suites
- Utilities included
- High security

Cost:

- **CAD $900 – $1,200/month**

3.4 ALMA @ ByWard Market

Type: Premium student housing

Features:

- Fully furnished
- Study lounges, gym
- Central location

Cost:

- **CAD $1,100 – $1,500/month**

3.5 The Revalie Ottawa

Type: Purpose-built student housing

Features:

- Private and shared units
- Fitness center, study rooms

Cost:

- **CAD $950 – $1,400/month**

3.6 Theo Ottawa

Type: Suite-style housing

Features:

- Fully furnished
- Student community environment

Cost:

- **CAD $1,000 – $1,300/month**

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4. Monthly Cost Breakdown (Full Budget)

Expense Category	Estimated Cost (CAD)
Rent	$700 – $1,500
Utilities	$50 – $150
Internet	Often included

Expense Category	Estimated Cost (CAD)
Food	$250 – $400
Transport	$100 – $130
Miscellaneous	$100 – $200

Total Monthly Budget:

👉 **CAD $1,200 – $2,200**

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5. Step-by-Step Booking Guide

Step 1: Decide Your Budget

- Under $800 → Shared housing
- $900–$1200 → Private room
- $1200+ → Studio/apartment

Step 2: Choose Platform

- Easy booking → University Living
- Cheap → Rentola
- Flexible → 4stay

Step 3: Shortlist Property

Check:

- Distance to university
- Included utilities
- Furnishing

Step 4: Verify Listing

- Ask for photos/videos
- Check reviews

- Confirm lease terms

Step 5: Pay Deposit

- Usually **1 month rent**
- Avoid full payment upfront

Step 6: Sign Lease

- Read contract carefully
- Check:
    - Lease duration
    - Refund policy
    - Maintenance rules

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6. Best Areas for Students (With Cost)

Sandy Hill

- Closest to university
- Rent: **$650 – $1,200**

Centretown

- Downtown lifestyle
- Rent: **$800 – $1,500**

Old Ottawa South

- Quiet area
- Rent: **$600 – $1,000**

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7. Important Tips Before Booking

- Start searching **4–6 months early**
- Always **visit or request virtual tour**
- Never send money without verification

- Check if utilities are included
- Confirm Wi-Fi availability

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8. Avoiding Scams

- Avoid deals that seem too cheap
- Never pay via unknown links
- Use trusted platforms only
- Verify landlord identity

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9. Final Recommendation

For most students:

- **Best overall:** University Living
- **Best budget option:** Rentola
- **Best premium housing:** ALMA / Revalie
- **Best short-term stay:** 4stay

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10. Conclusion

Ottawa offers a wide range of student housing options suitable for every budget. By using verified platforms, understanding costs, and following proper booking steps, students can secure safe and comfortable accommodation before arrival.

Link : Student Housing Ottawa - Student Rentals, Apartments & Rooms for Rent
Student Housing in Ottawa, ON - University Living